

Competition Regulations

for the international FCI-StöPr competition 2027 in Austria



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The German text is the original version.

1. Organisation

The “International FCI-StöPr competition” will be held in accordance with the FCI article search regulations (FCI-StöPr 1–3). All participants will compete on two consecutive days, analogous to the FCI-IBGH Special.

The valid International Utility Dogs Regulations (IGP) of the FCI, and in particular the provisions of the FCI article search regulation (FCI-StöPr), form the basis of the event and are binding for all participants and officials.

Participants will be informed in due time about the characteristics of the search area. A training area comparable to the actual competition terrain will be made available for training purposes.

Violations of the Austrian Animal Welfare Act in connection with the event will result in immediate disqualification. The same applies to any form of manipulation or doping of the dog.

Sick or injured dogs are not permitted to participate. Any measures intended to improperly influence the dog's appearance, performance, behaviour, or character, or to conceal signs of injury or illness, are strictly prohibited.

2. Competition Procedure

Before the start of the competition, all dogs must undergo a veterinary inspection. Dogs showing signs of illness or suspected contagious diseases will not be admitted.

Females in season are permitted to participate, provided they are kept separate from the other competitors. The veterinary inspection must be completed before the draw takes place.

Prior to the competition, a team leaders' meeting will be held. The judges, organising committee, trial director, and team leaders are required to attend. During this meeting, the order in which the countries participate in the draw will be determined by lot. The host country will automatically receive the last draw position.

The public draw for the starting order will take place on the evening before the competition. The allocated catalogue/start number must be visibly displayed throughout the event.

During the award ceremony, the results of both the individual and team classifications will be announced. The national anthem of the winning individual competitor and the winning team should be played. In addition, all positively qualified participants and teams should be announced by name.

3. Eligibility and Entry Limits

The number of participants is limited to a maximum of 50 competitors per level.

Only members of a national canine organisation (NCO/NHV) affiliated with or recognised by the FCI are eligible to participate.

Regardless of nationality, a handler may compete for only one country and may handle only one dog.

Dogs not registered in a studbook or appendix register are also eligible to participate. Registration must in all cases be submitted by the respective national organisation or an authorised representative.

The maximum number of competitors per country is:

- 3 handlers in FCI-StöPr 1 and FCI-StöPr 2
- 5 handlers in FCI-StöPr 3

If the maximum number of 50 participants per level is not reached, the ÖKV Commission for Tracking and Article Search may, in consultation with the organising committee, allow additional reserve competitors to start.

If the number of reserve competitors exceeds the number of available starting places, the participating teams that may fill the vacant places will be determined by draw during the team leaders' meeting before the country draw.

The decision regarding the admission of reserve competitors must be communicated to the team leaders no later than eight days after the closing date for entries.

Each national organisation may additionally nominate two reserve competitors. These reserve competitors will also be listed in the catalogue. If a registered participant withdraws due to illness, accident, or non-attendance, only an officially registered reserve competitor with the registered dog may replace them.

4. Registration

All participant registrations must be submitted collectively by the respective national organisation to the organising committee before the entry deadline stated in the invitation.

The registration must include the following information:

- Name of the national organisation (NHV/NCO)
- Name, address, telephone number, and e-mail address of the team leader
- Name, address, telephone number, and e-mail address of the participants and reserve participants
- Name of the dog
- Breed (if applicable)
- Date of birth
- Studbook number (if available)
- Identification number (microchip, tattoo, etc.)
- Training title/qualification

Registrations must be submitted by the national organisation or an authorised representative.

Entries that cannot be accepted must be communicated immediately in writing to the respective national organisation.

5. Scorebook / Performance Record

All participants must present a scorebook/performance record issued by their national organisation. The scorebooks must be submitted to the organiser before the start of the competition.

If the national organisation does not issue scorebooks, an electronic performance record may be presented instead.

The designation “International FCI-StöPr competition” together with the achieved result must be clearly entered in the scorebook or electronic performance record of each participant.

6. Ranking and Titles

The competitor achieving the highest total score with a passed qualification will be declared the winner and awarded the title „**Internationaler FCI-StöPr Sieger 2027**“.

In the event of a tie, the higher individual score will determine the ranking. If the individual scores are also identical, the competitors will be placed ex aequo.

In the final ranking list, all handlers with a passed qualification (AKZ) will be listed first. The remaining competitors will then follow according to their achieved scores.

For the team classification, the highest positive total score achieved by one competitor per level for each country will be counted.

The winning team is the team with the highest total score. In the event of a tie, the better individual result in FCI-StöPr 3 will decide the ranking. If these results are also identical, the teams will be ranked ex aequo.

To be included in the team classification, at least two positive results must be achieved.